Redirect Check Report

Sample report - fictional site

larkspurdental.test
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31 of 50 old pages (62%) send visitors to the right place. 19 pages need attention before they cost you traffic. Fix first: 5 broken pages and 4 pages that land on the wrong content.

2 Pages stuck in a loop **3** Pages that lead nowhere

4 Pages that land on the wrong page

2 Pages that look fine but show nothing useful **6** Pages that take extra steps

2 Pages using a temporary redirect **31** working correctly

Pages stuck in a loop (2)

The redirects send visitors in a circle, so the page never loads.

> **Suggested fix:** Find the conflicting redirect rules and remove one.

Old URL	Where it should go	Where it actually goes	What happened	Fix
`/locations/`	`/our-office/`	`/locations/` *does not load*	The redirects go round in a circle and the page never loads.	Find the conflicting redirect rules and remove one, so it goes straight to /our-office/.
`/new-patients/`	`/patients/new/`	`/new-patients/` *does not load*	The redirects go round in a circle and the page never loads.	Find the conflicting redirect rules and remove one, so it goes straight to /patients/new/.

Pages that lead nowhere (3)

Visitors and search engines hit an error page, so the ranking and links these pages earned are being lost.

> **Suggested fix:** Redirect each one to the closest matching new page.

Old URL	Where it should go	Where it actually goes	What happened	Fix
`/free-consultation-2019/`	`/free-consultation/`	`/free-consultation-2019/` *does not load*	It ends on a “page not found” error.	Redirect it to /free-consultation/.
`/blog/2017/09/back-to-school-smiles/`	`/back-to-school-smiles/`	`/back-to-school-smile/` *does not load*	It ends on a “page not found” error.	Redirect it to /back-to-school-smiles/.
`/wp-content/uploads/2017/post-op-instructions.pdf`	`/patients/forms/post-op-instructions.pdf`	`/wp-content/uploads/2017/post-op-instructions.pdf` *does not load*	The website shows a server error.	Redirect it to /patients/forms/post-op-instructions.pdf.

Pages that land on the wrong page (4)

The redirect works, but it takes visitors somewhere other than intended.

> **Suggested fix:** Update the redirect to point to the expected page.

Old URL	Where it should go	Where it actually goes	What happened	Fix
`/services/dental-implants.html`	`/dental-implants/`	`/general-dentistry/`	It goes to a different page than planned.	Update the redirect to /dental-implants/.
`/about/staff/hygienist/`	`/our-team/hygienist/`	`/our-team/`	It goes to a different page than planned.	Update the redirect to /our-team/hygienist/.
`/insurance.html`	`/patients/insurance/`	`/contact/`	It goes to a different page than planned.	Update the redirect to /patients/insurance/.
`/services/pediatric.html`	`/childrens-dentistry/`	`/cosmetic-dentistry/`	It goes to a different page than planned.	Update the redirect to /childrens-dentistry/.

Pages that look fine but show nothing useful (2)

The page loads, but it is empty, a “page not found” message, or the homepage instead of the content visitors wanted.

> **Suggested fix:** Redirect to a relevant page, or remove the old URL from the sitemap and links.

Old URL	Where it should go	Where it actually goes	What happened	Fix
`/services/sedation.html`	`/sedation-dentistry/`	`/`	It sends visitors to the homepage instead of a matching page.	Redirect it to /sedation-dentistry/, or remove the old URL from the sitemap and links.
`/blog/2019/11/holiday-office-hours/`	`/holiday-office-hours/`	`/holiday-office-hours/`	The page loads but says the content cannot be found.	Redirect it to /holiday-office-hours/, or remove the old URL from the sitemap and links.

Pages that take extra steps (6)

Visitors are bounced through several redirects before arriving, which slows the page and dilutes its search value.

> **Suggested fix:** Point the old URL straight to the final page.

Old URL	Where it should go	Where it actually goes	What happened	Fix
`/blog/2018/03/spring-allergies-and-tooth-pain/`	`/spring-allergies-and-tooth-pain/`	`/spring-allergies-and-tooth-pain/`	It takes 2 redirects to get there.	Point it straight to /spring-allergies-and-tooth-pain/.
`/blog/2018/07/fluoride-facts/`	`/fluoride-facts/`	`/fluoride-facts/`	It takes 2 redirects to get there.	Point it straight to /fluoride-facts/.
`/blog/2018/11/thanksgiving-smile-tips/`	`/thanksgiving-smile-tips/`	`/thanksgiving-smile-tips/`	It takes 2 redirects to get there.	Point it straight to /thanksgiving-smile-tips/.
`/services/crowns.html`	`/restorative-dentistry/`	`/restorative-dentistry/`	It takes 2 redirects to get there.	Point it straight to /restorative-dentistry/.
`/services/bridges.html`	`/restorative-dentistry/`	`/restorative-dentistry/`	It takes 2 redirects to get there.	Point it straight to /restorative-dentistry/.

Old URL	Where it should go	Where it actually goes	What happened	Fix
`/emergency.php`	`/emergency-dentist/`	`/emergency-dentist/`	It takes 3 redirects to get there.	Point it straight to /emergency-dentist/.

Pages using a temporary redirect (2)

Search engines may keep the old URL indexed instead of the new one.

> **Suggested fix:** Change the redirect to a permanent one (301).

Old URL	Where it should go	Where it actually goes	What happened	Fix
`/book-online.php`	`/appointments/`	`/appointments/`	It gets there, but with a temporary redirect.	Change the redirect to a permanent one (301).
`/patient-portal/`	`/patients/portal/`	`/patients/portal/`	It gets there, but with a temporary redirect.	Change the redirect to a permanent one (301).

What to do next

1. Fix the loops and broken pages first.
2. Then correct the wrong destinations.
3. Clean up chains and temporary redirects when time allows.

Fixed some of these? Send us the updated redirects and we'll re-check them within 14 days at no extra charge.

Want the whole site checked? Up to 1,000 URLs for $99.

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